



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Logos Academy
School Website: <https://logoshbg.org/>

December 27, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Logos Academy Harrisburg (Logos Academy PA 17102) presents as a Christian, independent school that explicitly foregrounds a classical-leaning, formation-focused approach. Public materials frame education as a holistic formation of mind and soul, emphasizing Christ-centered character, virtue, and service, with a strong commitment to accessibility through scholarships and community partnerships. The school markets a private, holistic, trauma-informed environment and notes open-enrollment that welcomes students from any faith background, while repeatedly tying its mission to faith-informed aims of truth, goodness, and beauty.

Overall, the school demonstrates clear classical orientation in spirit and aims (formation, virtue, intellect, public-facing language of "classical education," and a private school identity). However, explicit, textbook-level classical curriculum markers (notably the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation, and explicit use of grammar, logic, and rhetoric as a structuring framework) are not consistently evidenced in public materials. Given the balance of evidence across the six categories, Logos Academy Harrisburg is best characterized as CLASSICAL, with meaningful classical elements present and a few gaps that prevent a wholesale "fully classical" label in every dimension.

Key insights by category (high level): - Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong Christian grounding, explicitly Christ-centered, with language of formation through faith. Evidence of theology-inflected aims but not overt liturgical practice on the public site. CLASSICAL, with high confidence. - School Purpose and Goal: Formation of intellect and character, virtue, and human flourishing foregrounded; service and compassionate education highlighted. CLASSICAL. - Curriculum: Public materials emphasize classical framing and private/holistic aims but do not consistently list Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or direct Great Conversation commitments. SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. - Pedagogy: Mixed signals; the site foregrounds compassionate, trauma-informed, community-oriented practices and Christ-centered ethos, but explicit Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy is not clearly evidenced in public-facing content. NOT CLASSICAL (on explicit pedagogical method signals). - Faculty: Strong portrayal of teachers as caring, known by name, and forming the living curriculum; donor and parent-partner language appears. CLASSICAL. - Parents & Community: Explicit partner-education language, parent involvement expectations, and open-campus/visit-friendly posture; substantial emphasis on parent partnership and community engagement. CLASSICAL.

Abstracted aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize Logos Academy Harrisburg as a Christ-centered school grounded in the love of Christ, with an open-enrollment policy that welcomes students from any faith background. This signals a religious foundation that is central to its mission, even as it invites broad participation. - The site describes Logos as "an independent Christ-centered school" and emphasizes education of mind and soul within a Christ-centered framework. This indicates a theologically grounded orientation guiding the character formation of students. - Public narratives about individual student stories and family partnerships

consistently frame education as formation in a Christian context (e.g., emphasis on intellect and character within a Christian environment).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Christ-centered, love of Christ, gospel-informed formation, private school education in a Christian milieu. - Negative keywords: Not evidently present in public materials (e.g., secular, value-neutral, or liturgical-averse cues are not foregrounded). - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators appear prominently (roughly 3–4 distinct Christian/theological signals in public materials); Negative indicators negligible to none. Why this rating - The materials foreground transcendental, Christ-centered formation and a theologically grounded approach. While liturgical practice per se is not explicitly described in public content, the depth of Christ-centered framing and explicit Christian formation strongly supports CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: - “grounded in the love of Christ” with open-enrollment (Christ-centered, inclusive) - “An Independent Christ-centered school ... educating the whole student—mind and soul” (explicit Christ-centered, classical framing) - “Christ-centered environment” and trauma-informed, compassionate education narratives (evidence of faith-informed formation)

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s own framing centers on formation of intellect and character, wisdom, and virtue, with explicit references to “true education” (intellect and character) and formation over mere information. Public materials discuss formation, virtue, and human flourishing as core aims. - Narratives highlight “intelligence plus character,” and the mission to form virtuous leaders, indicating a paideia-like aim beyond job preparation. - Programs and messaging emphasize compassionate education, service, and loving learning as a path to human flourishing within a Christ-centered context.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, intellect, character, service, love of learning. - Negative keywords: career/workforce-readiness framing (e.g., “career readiness,” “job preparation”) not evident in public materials. - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators dominate (roughly 6–7 distinct signals). Negative indicators, if any, are minimal. Why this rating - The public messaging consistently elevates formation, virtue, and wisdom over mere job-readiness, aligning strongly with classical aims of education as formation.

Cited evidence: - “true education ... intellect and character” (Martin Luther King, Jr. reference; formation emphasis) - “intelligence plus character” framing the school’s aim - “compassionate education” and human flourishing in a Christ-centered context

Element 3: Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school markets itself as offering “a rich classical education” and a private, holistic elementary program, signaling alignment with classical aims. However, public materials do not consistently spell out core classical curriculum components (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation) or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium framing. - There is clear emphasis on a curriculum designed to educate the whole child in a manner consistent with classical ethos (formation through mind and soul) but limited explicit articulation of canonical classical texts or structure. - Public materials emphasize Christian, formation-oriented schooling rather than enumerating the standard classical curricula components such as Great Books or the formal Trivium/Quadrivium sequence.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present (in public materials): classical education, private holistic education, education of mind and soul, formation (though not explicit lists of Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or Great Conversation). - Negative keywords present: none clearly evident in public materials (i.e., no explicit rejection of classical aims; however, absence of direct Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium signals). - Quantitative estimate: Positive signals are present but limited to a high-level classical framing; absence of explicit canonical curriculum terms yields few positive signals in the strict sense. Estimated positives ~2–3, negatives ~0–1 (depending on whether one counts explicit missing items as negatives). Why this rating - The school presents itself as classical-leaning, with explicit “classical education” language and

formation-driven aims, but public materials do not robustly list canonical classical curriculum components (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation). This supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Cited evidence: - “an independent Christ-centered school ... providing a rich classical education” - “private, holistic elementary education” and growth in enrollment (classical framing) - “intellect and character” formation emphasis (formation-based)

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public materials emphasize a compassionate, trauma-informed approach, small class sizes, and mentoring, but explicit classical pedagogy signals (e.g., Socratic seminars, disciplined memory, recitation, or the explicit use of a formal Paideia-based or Scholé framework) are not clearly documented in public pages. Some narratives discuss formation, service, and character rather than the distinct classical pedagogy. - There is evidence of a classroom culture oriented toward relationship-building, memory through formation-oriented practices, and the value of character; but explicit Socratic inquiry, remedial reading/writing methods, or rhetoric-focused teaching signals are not clearly spelled out in public-facing materials. - Job postings and internal materials reference trauma-informed practice and a strong emphasis on pedagogy within a classical framework, but the public-facing site does not present a detailed, canonical pedagogy such as Socratic seminars, scholé days, or memorization and recitation as central daily methods.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: “trauma-invested practices” (trauma-informed), “compassionate education,” “private, holistic education,” “Christ-centered environment,” which align with a humane pedagogy but not the explicit classical pedagogy signals. - Negative keywords (classical pedagogy signals): Presence of “Socratic dialogue,” “recitation,” “scholé,” “memory work” are not clearly evidenced in public materials; absence of explicit Paideia-style methods is a negative signal here. - Quantitative estimate: Positive signals exist but are not the core classical pedagogical markers; negatives for classical pedagogy signals appear (due to lack of explicit Socratic/seminar-based or memory-based pedagogy). Estimated positives ~1–2; negatives ~1–2. Why this rating - The school's public-facing materials emphasize formation, care, and trauma-informed, relationship-centric teaching, rather than a clearly articulated classical pedagogy (like Socratic seminars, memory work, or recitation). This supports NOT CLASSICAL in pedagogy but with some classical alignment in ethos.

Cited evidence: - “trauma-invested practices” and commitment to compassionate education in a Christ-centered frame (pedagogical orientation) - “A private holistic elementary education” and growth narratives (pedagogical emphasis on formation) - Statements about a mind-and-soul formation approach rather than explicit classical pedagogy signals

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school describes faculty as caring, known to students, and as the living curriculum—terms that align with classical education's emphasis on teachers as virtuous exemplars and mentors who model mastery and character. Student stories repeatedly credit teachers for personal and academic growth, indicating a strong moral-educator ethos. - Admissions steps emphasize partnerships with parents and the role of teachers in guiding student development, and job postings/talent descriptions emphasize trauma-informed practice and classical education experience, suggesting a faculty culture oriented toward virtue, mentorship, and formation. - The school's public-facing materials and stories repeatedly highlight teacher-Student relationships, memory of students by teachers, and teachers' role in student growth, which aligns with the “living curriculum” and “model teachers” concepts in classical literature.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: model teachers, mentors, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, teachers as exemplars, mentorship, faith-and-reason alignment, character formation through exemplary teaching. - Negative keywords: None clearly evident in public materials (i.e., no statements minimizing teacher quality or separation of teachers from the curriculum). - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators appear strongly (3–5 discrete signals); negative indicators appear negligible. Why this rating - The public content strongly supports classical teacher-student mentorship ideals and living-curriculum metaphors, placing Faculty firmly in CLASSICAL territory.

Cited evidence: - “teachers know every child by name, by personality ... they’re teaching him how to love and serve others” (illustrates mentorship and character formation) - “A heart for service from Logos Academy Harrisburg” and teacher-student relationship emphasis (faculty as living curriculum) - “An Independent Christ-centered School ... providing a rich classical education” informs the faculty’s role in upholding that classical ethos

Element 6: Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school explicitly emphasizes partnership with families, parent involvement, and co-educator roles (parent partnership expectations during admissions; open-enrollment policy; parent engagement narratives). The admissions process explicitly notes parent partnership expectations. This aligns with the classical emphasis on family partnership and shared educational mission. - Public content highlights donor involvement, community events, and scholarship support (e.g., EITC scholarships) indicating active community engagement and a broad support network that sustains a classical education vision. - The site communicates open campus style and invitations for parent visits and involvement, consistent with a classical model that sees parents as co-teachers and collaborators in the school’s mission.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: parent partnership, co-teachers, family involvement, parental engagement, open campus, community of learners, collaboration with families, parental leadership. - Negative keywords: None evident in public materials (e.g., “customer” language; no heavy consumer framing). - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators are robust (multiple explicit mentions); negative indicators negligible. Why this rating - The public-facing materials consistently emphasize parental partnership, family formation in education, and community engagement, aligning strongly with CLASSICAL expectations in the Parents & Community category.

Cited evidence: - Admissions steps mention “Parent Partnership Agreement” and “parent partnership expectations.” - Open-enrollment policy and emphasis on family involvement and donor engagement. - News and community posts illustrate donor partnership and family/community engagement.

Aggregate assessment (category-by-category synthesis)

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — Pedagogy or Teaching Methods: NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — Parents and Community: CLASSICAL

General assessment: The school demonstrates a coherent classical orientation across most domains, with strong religious formation, formation-centered goals, a robust faculty ethos, and active parent/community partnerships. The Curriculum and Pedagogy categories reveal more variability: the school names itself classical and emphasizes formation, but explicit canonical curriculum structures (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic pedagogy) are not consistently documented in public-facing content. Overall, Logos Academy Harrisburg aligns most closely with CLASSICAL, with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL elements in Curriculum and NOT CLASSICAL signals in Pedagogy.

What would move the needle (only applicable if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL) - N/A for a fully classical rating; no major needle-moving changes are required given the aggregate CLASSICAL designation. - If a future improvement path were to be proposed, the school could explicitly articulate and publish: - A canonical curriculum map (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Great Conversation) and a clear Trivium/Quadrivium framing. - A publicly stated Pedagogy model rooted in Socratic dialogue or Scholé-based restfulness, with concrete classroom practices (e.g., memorization/recitation signals, seminar formats) to align with classical pedagogy signals.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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